

Partner Revenue OS - End-to-End Business Workflow Manual

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Partner Revenue OS — End-to-End Business Workflow Manual

Document type: Product OS / Business Workflow Operating Manual

Product: Partner Revenue OS

Section focus: End-to-end business workflow across partner strategy, onboarding, claims, attribution, integrations, finance readiness, statements, disputes, reporting, and investment decisions

Source of truth: Partner Revenue OS PDR v3, with Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub as an extension layer

Strategic positioning: Partner Revenue Control Layer / Partner Revenue Operating System

Core object: Partner Revenue Claim

Primary functional owner: Head of Partnerships / Partnerships Leader

Primary executive validators: CRO, CFO, CEO / GM

Deployment posture: Overlay + integrations first; selective system of record for partner revenue claims over time

0. Executive Summary

Partner Revenue OS exists to help companies run partnerships like a predictable revenue line. The product should not behave like a generic PRM, affiliate tracker, partner portal, dashboard, contract repository, or commission calculator. Its job is to create a controlled operating layer where partner activity becomes attributable, governable, forecastable, finance-ready, and investable.

The central business workflow is:

- Partner strategy
 - partner sourcing
 - partner qualification
 - partner approval
 - agreement and rule setup
 - partner onboarding
 - ecosystem touchpoint capture
 - partner revenue claim creation
 - claim preflight
 - attribution decision
 - protection window
 - CRM linkage
 - revenue event validation
 - payout eligibility
 - finance evidence
 - partner statement
 - dispute management
 - settlement readiness
 - performance review
 - executive investment decision

The product must make this workflow seamless across the company. Partnerships touch many functions: partnerships, sales, RevOps, finance, legal, customer success, product, IT, and executive leadership. The OS should connect these teams through one controlled revenue workflow instead of scattered spreadsheets, CRM notes, WhatsApp messages, emails, contract PDFs, and manual payout files.

The **Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub** expands the existing structure by adding a broader attribution intelligence layer. The current OS governs partner revenue claims. The Hub captures the wider ecosystem activity around accounts, contacts, opportunities, implementation, renewals, expansion, marketplaces, co-sell motions, and strategic alliances. The claim remains the atomic control object, but the Hub adds the event and intelligence layer around it.

In simple terms:

1. Core Operating Principles

1.1 Keep the Partner Revenue Claim as the atomic object

The OS should not be centered only on the partner profile or the CRM opportunity. A partner profile tells the company who the partner is. A CRM opportunity tells the company what sales is working on. The **Partner Revenue Claim** tells the company that a partner believes it contributed to a commercial outcome and that the organization must decide whether the claim is valid, protected, attributable, agreement-covered, revenue-linked, payout-relevant, finance-ready, and reportable.

The Partner Revenue Claim connects:

- partner
- customer/account
- contact
- opportunity/deal
- partner role
- partner program
- agreement
- agreement rule
- protection window
- attribution status
- evidence
- ecosystem touchpoints
- revenue event
- payout eligibility
- approvals
- disputes
- partner statement
- audit history

1.2 Separate contribution, attribution, and payout

A partner may contribute without being payout-eligible. A partner may be attributed for strategic reporting but not eligible for commission. A partner may support implementation or renewal without having sourced the deal. The OS must separate these four concepts:

Contribution = the partner did something meaningful.
Attribution = the company formally recognizes that contribution.
Commercial eligibility = the contribution creates a contractual right or obligation.
Payout eligibility = finance can approve a payable amount based on revenue evidence and agreement rules.

This separation is essential. Without it, the company either overpays partners or underreports partner influence.

1.3 CRM, ERP, and billing remain systems of record for their domains

The OS should not replace CRM, ERP, billing, or accounting systems. It should integrate with them.

- CRM remains the system of record for accounts, contacts, opportunities, stages, owners, and sales pipeline.
- ERP/accounting remains the system of record for invoices, payments, GL references, vendor records, tax, and accounting controls.

- Billing/subscription systems remain the system of record for subscriptions, invoices, collections, renewals, upgrades, refunds, and cancellations.
- Partner Revenue OS becomes the system of record for partner revenue claims, attribution decisions, protection windows, agreement rule metadata, payout eligibility, partner revenue evidence, disputes, partner statements, and partner revenue intelligence.

1.4 Governance must come before automation

The product should not start by automating payments. It should start by proving entitlement. Once attribution, agreement rules, revenue validation, and finance evidence are trusted, payment automation becomes safer.

The maturity path should be:

```
Manual-safe workflow
→ controlled claim ledger
→ attribution integrity
→ finance evidence
→ payout eligibility
→ reconciliation
→ settlement automation
```

1.5 Every workflow should create an audit trail

The OS must preserve who did what, when, why, using which evidence, under which rule, and with which approval. This is required for partner trust, sales alignment, finance control, legal defensibility, and executive confidence.

2. End-to-End Workflow Map

2.1 Master workflow

```
flowchart TD
    A[Define partner strategy] --> B[Source and intake partners]
    B --> C[Qualify partner]
    C --> D[Approve partner]
    D --> E[Set agreement and rulebook]
    E --> F[Onboard and activate partner]
    F --> G[Capture ecosystem touchpoints]
    G --> H[Create Partner Revenue Claim]
    H --> I[Run claim preflight]
    I --> J[Make attribution decision]
    J --> K[Apply protection window]
    K --> L[Link to CRM opportunity]
    L --> M[Validate revenue event]
    M --> N[Determine payout eligibility]
    N --> O[Create finance evidence pack]
    O --> P[Update partner statement]
    P --> Q[Manage disputes and adjustments]
    Q --> R[Reconcile and prepare settlement]
    R --> S[Review performance]
    S --> T[Make executive investment decision]
```

2.2 Backend process architecture

```
Business event occurs
→ product creates or updates domain object
→ system checks rules and data quality
→ workflow routes to owner or approver
→ integrations read or write external data
→ audit log records the event
→ dashboard and statements update
→ exception queue catches problems
→ governance cadence converts data into decisions
```

2.3 Operating layers involved

PDR Layer	Role in the workflow
Partner Operating Layer	Manages partner identity, lifecycle, contacts, ownership, onboarding, and status
Partner Revenue Claim Ledger	Captures the formal commercial claim that a partner contributed to revenue
Attribution and Protection Layer	Determines credit, contribution validity, duplicate status, conflict, and protection windows
Agreement and Rule Engine	Translates commercial terms into operational rules
Revenue and Payout Eligibility Layer	Converts attribution into finance-readable economics
Governance and Operating Cadence Layer	Creates review rituals, scorecards, and leadership decision packs
Intelligence and Forecasting Layer	Produces partner ROI, forecasts, scoring, risks, and investment recommendations
Platform, Admin, Security, and Integration Layer	Provides permissions, audit, integrations, sync monitoring, localization, and admin control
Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub	Adds touchpoint-level ecosystem contribution capture, scoring, multi-touch attribution, and account-level journey intelligence

PART A — BUSINESS WORKFLOW BY PHASE

Phase 1 — Define Partner Strategy and Program Thesis

Business purpose

The company defines why partnerships exist. This prevents random partner activity and makes the partner function measurable. The strategic question is:

Which commercial constraint are partnerships solving?

Common reasons include:

- market access
- customer trust
- reseller distribution
- implementation capacity
- co-selling leverage
- product integration
- ecosystem credibility
- geographic expansion
- retention support
- renewal and expansion influence
- lower customer acquisition cost
- variable-cost growth

Trigger

This phase starts when leadership wants to launch, formalize, or redesign a partnership program.

Main actors

Role	Responsibility
CEO / GM	Defines strategic ambition and approves investment logic

Role	Responsibility
CRO	Validates revenue relevance and sales alignment
CFO	Validates economics and cost-control requirements
Head of Partnerships	Owns program design and operating model
Strategy / RevOps	Supports segmentation, KPI design, and process architecture
Product / CS	Validates whether partners influence implementation, adoption, retention, or expansion

Product capabilities required

- Partner Strategy Workspace
- Partner Program object
- Program KPI setup
- Partner type taxonomy
- Program approval workflow
- Executive program thesis template
- Business case fields
- Program risk scoring

Backend business process

1. User creates Partner Program.
2. User selects program objective.
3. System requires target customer segment, partner type, geography, products, and revenue motion.
4. System requires primary KPI and secondary KPIs.
5. System assigns executive validators based on program type.
6. Program enters approval workflow.
7. Approved program becomes selectable in partner intake, agreement setup, claims, attribution rules, and dashboards.
8. Audit log records program creation and approvals.

Required data fields

- program name
- program owner
- program objective
- target customer segment
- target partner type
- target geography
- target products
- commercial model
- attribution model
- payout model
- expected revenue contribution
- expected cost
- approval owner
- risk rating
- launch date
- review cadence

Integrations

At this stage, integrations are optional. However, the product may pull segmentation data from CRM or data warehouse if available.

Controls

- Program cannot become active without an owner.
- Program cannot accept partners without a defined partner type.
- Program cannot generate payout eligibility without an attached agreement rulebook.
- Program should have a review cadence.

Output

A structured **Partner Program Thesis**.

Rationale

Most partner chaos starts because the company never defines why a partnership exists. A partner program must be connected to a clear business reason. Without this step, the OS becomes a tracker of random relationships instead of a control layer for revenue.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Connects to Partner Registry, Agreement Rulebook, Attribution Workflow, Command Center
Replaces	Informal strategy documents, verbal partner program logic, scattered leadership assumptions
Adds	Structured program thesis, KPI model, executive approval, program-level attribution model

KPIs

- number of active partner programs
- percentage of partners attached to a program
- percentage of programs with clear KPIs
- program approval cycle time
- program-level revenue contribution

Phase 2 — Build Partner Segmentation and Ecosystem Map

Business purpose

The company identifies which partner types matter and how they fit into the commercial system. This is the foundation of the Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub because attribution depends on partner role.

Partner segments

- source / referrer
- influencer
- co-seller
- reseller
- distributor
- implementation partner
- marketplace partner
- strategic alliance partner
- affiliate
- white-label partner
- franchise partner
- service delivery partner
- technology integration partner
- advisory / consultant partner
- ecosystem platform partner

Product capabilities required

- Partner Role Taxonomy
- Ecosystem Actor Registry
- Ecosystem Relationship Graph
- Partner type configuration
- Journey-stage contribution mapping
- Partner capability profile
- Partner segment performance analytics

Backend business process

1. Admin defines partner role taxonomy.
2. Each partner role is linked to allowed contribution types.
3. Each role is linked to required evidence types.
4. Each role is linked to default attribution rules.
5. Each role is linked to default protection windows.
6. Each role is linked to eligible commercial models.
7. System uses role taxonomy during intake, agreement setup, claim review, attribution scoring, and payout eligibility.

Required data fields

- role name
- role description
- allowed claim types
- allowed touchpoint types
- eligible products
- eligible geographies
- evidence requirement
- default attribution method
- default protection window
- default approval path
- default payout model
- risk level

Controls

- A partner cannot submit claim types outside its configured role unless an override is approved.
- Partner role changes require audit log and effective date.
- Commercial rules must be re-evaluated when partner role changes.

Rationale

Different partners create value differently. A reseller, implementation partner, referral partner, marketplace partner, and strategic alliance should not share one attribution logic. Role clarity prevents wrong payouts, partner conflict, and misleading executive reporting.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Partner Registry, Claim Ledger, Attribution Rules, Agreement Rulebook
Replaces	Generic partner type labels with role-specific operating logic
Adds	Contribution taxonomy, role-based attribution, role-based evidence and approval paths

KPIs

- percentage of partners with valid role classification

- number of active partner roles
 - partner contribution by role
 - claim acceptance by role
 - dispute rate by role
 - partner ROI by role
-

Phase 3 — Source and Intake Potential Partners

Business purpose

The company captures every potential partner before commitments become informal promises. Partner intake creates visibility and prevents ungoverned relationship activity.

Sources of partners

- founder and executive relationships
- sales introductions
- inbound applications
- events and conferences
- customer referrals
- ecosystem mapping
- agencies and consultants
- resellers and distributors
- marketplaces
- system integrators
- banks and financial institutions
- government and institutional programs
- regional strategic partners

Product capabilities required

- Partner Intake Form
- Inbound Partner Application
- Internal Partner Nomination
- Partner Source Tracking
- Duplicate Partner Detection
- Partner Intake Queue
- Partner Intake Approval Routing

Backend business process

1. Partner prospect is submitted through internal intake or external application.
2. System checks for duplicate partner entity.
3. System assigns provisional partner role and source.
4. System checks whether partner aligns to an active Partner Program.
5. System assigns owner based on program, geography, or partner type.
6. System creates intake record and routes to qualification queue.
7. If duplicate is detected, system links intake to existing partner profile or creates merge review task.
8. Audit log records submission source and owner assignment.

Required data fields

- partner legal name
- trade name
- website/domain
- country

- region
- partner source
- proposed partner type
- target customer segment
- expected contribution
- internal sponsor
- contact person
- email
- phone
- commercial interest
- notes
- duplicate match confidence

Integrations

- CRM account/contact lookup
- data enrichment providers where needed
- website/domain verification
- email domain matching
- optional KYC/KYB lookup for regulated sectors

Controls

- Every partner must have a source.
- Every partner must have an owner.
- Duplicate detection must happen before qualification.
- External partner applications should not automatically create active partner records.

Output

A structured **Partner Intake Record**.

Rationale

Partner relationships often begin informally. Intake converts informal interest into a visible pipeline. This protects the company from hidden promises, duplicate partner records, unmanaged expectations, and premature commitments.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Partner Registry, Partner Program, CRM, Ecosystem Actor Registry
Replaces	Email requests, WhatsApp introductions, untracked executive referrals
Adds	Partner intake queue, source tracking, duplicate detection, owner assignment

KPIs

- partner intake volume
- intake-to-qualified conversion rate
- duplicate partner rate
- average intake review time
- source quality by conversion rate

Phase 4 — Qualify Partner Fit

Business purpose

The company decides whether a partner is worth activating. Not every partner should be accepted. A bad partner creates cost, confusion, sales conflict, support burden, and payout risk.

Qualification dimensions

- strategic fit
- commercial potential
- customer overlap
- market access
- relationship strength
- trust role
- implementation capability
- technical capability
- regional relevance
- compliance risk
- brand risk
- operational complexity
- expected ROI
- sales conflict risk
- finance complexity

Product capabilities required

- Partner Qualification Scorecard
- Partner Fit Scoring
- Risk Flagging
- Internal Review Workflow
- Qualification Notes
- Approval Recommendation

Backend business process

1. Intake record enters qualification.
2. System loads qualification template based on partner role and program.
3. Partner manager completes business fit section.
4. Sales validates account overlap and conflict risk.
5. RevOps validates CRM/account mapping implications.
6. Finance validates commercial complexity and payout risk.
7. Legal/compliance validates restricted sectors or documentation requirements.
8. System calculates partner fit score and risk score.
9. Decision is recorded: reject, park, nurture, pilot, or approve.
10. If approved, system creates or updates full Partner Profile.

Required data fields

- strategic fit score
- commercial potential score
- account overlap score
- capability score
- risk score
- complexity score
- expected contribution
- expected cost
- qualification decision

- decision owner
- decision date
- rejection reason if rejected

Controls

- Partners with high risk must route to legal/compliance.
- Partners with payout-bearing models must route to finance before activation.
- Partners cannot move to agreement stage without qualification decision.

Rationale

Partnerships are not free. Every partner consumes onboarding time, sales alignment, enablement, reporting, support, and finance governance. Qualification protects the company from partner portfolio bloat.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Partner Intake, Partner Registry, Legal, Finance, Sales, RevOps
Replaces	Unstructured “this partner seems good” decisions
Adds	Fit scoring, risk scoring, qualification gates, partner rejection logic

KPIs

- qualification completion time
- qualification-to-approval rate
- partner quality score
- rejected partner reasons
- high-risk partner percentage

Phase 5 — Approve Partner and Create Operating Record

Business purpose

The company formally approves the partner and creates the operational partner record. This is the moment where a potential relationship becomes a governed relationship.

Product capabilities required

- Partner Approval Workflow
- Partner Profile
- Approval Matrix
- Delegation of Authority
- Partner Lifecycle Status
- Audit Log

Backend business process

1. Qualified partner enters approval workflow.
2. System determines approvers based on partner type, program, geography, risk score, and commercial model.
3. Required approvers review qualification record.
4. Approvers approve, reject, request changes, or approve conditionally.
5. If approved, system creates active Partner Profile with lifecycle status = Approved.
6. System assigns owner, partner role, program, and next required workflow.
7. System locks qualification decision and records audit trail.

Approval logic examples

Scenario	Required approvers
Low-risk referral partner	Head of Partnerships or Partner Manager
Revenue-share partner	Partnerships + Finance
Reseller partner	Partnerships + Sales/CRO + Legal
Strategic alliance	Executive sponsor + Legal + Finance
Regulated sector partner	Compliance + Legal + Finance
Saudi payout-bearing partner	Finance + local documentation validation

Controls

- Approval authority should be configurable.
- Conditional approval must include unresolved conditions.
- Partner cannot be onboarded until approval is complete.
- All approvals require timestamp and approver identity.

Rationale

Approving a partner creates obligations. The company may owe the partner access, training, status visibility, protection, commercial rights, and eventually payout. Approval must therefore be governed.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Partner Registry, Approval Matrix, Legal, Finance, Compliance
Replaces	Informal “approved by conversation” logic
Adds	Formal approval trail, conditional approval, governance readiness

KPIs

- approval cycle time
- approval aging
- conditional approval rate
- approval rejection rate
- approver SLA compliance

Phase 6 — Structure Agreement and Rulebook

Business purpose

The company converts legal and commercial terms into executable rules. This is where the OS starts becoming a finance-control platform rather than a partner directory.

Product capabilities required

- Agreement Metadata
- Agreement Rulebook
- Commercial Rules Engine
- Contract Reference Link
- Rule Versioning
- Agreement Approval Workflow
- Rule Simulation later in maturity

Backend business process

1. Legal or partner owner uploads/links agreement.
2. System captures agreement metadata.
3. Commercial terms are translated into structured rules.
4. Rules are validated by partnerships, finance, and legal.
5. Rulebook is versioned with effective dates.
6. System links agreement to partner, program, role, products, geography, and claim types.
7. Active rules become available to claim preflight, attribution workflow, payout eligibility, and finance evidence.
8. Any later rule change creates a new rule version, not silent overwrite.

Agreement metadata fields

- agreement ID
- partner legal entity
- agreement type
- effective date
- expiry date
- auto-renewal terms
- termination terms
- eligible products
- eligible geographies
- eligible customer types
- eligible partner roles
- claim submission deadline
- attribution criteria
- protection window
- commission rate
- revenue-share rate
- payout trigger
- payout cadence
- cap/floor
- exclusions
- clawback/refund logic
- dispute process
- required documents
- tax requirements

Controls

- No payout eligibility without active agreement rule coverage unless manual executive exception exists.
- Agreement rule changes require version history.
- Expired agreements should trigger claim and payout warnings.
- Claims should be evaluated against the rule version active at the relevant time.

Rationale

Contracts are not operational by themselves. A PDF agreement says what should happen. The OS must make those terms usable in workflows, approvals, attribution, eligibility, and finance reporting.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Legal, CLM/e-signature, Partner Profile, Claim Ledger, Payout Eligibility
Replaces	Contract PDFs interpreted manually each time a claim appears

Type	Description
Adds	Executable commercial rules, versioning, rule-based eligibility, finance defensibility

KPIs

- percentage of active partners with agreement metadata
- percentage of claims linked to agreements
- agreement rule completeness score
- expired agreement risk count
- rule exception rate

Phase 7 — Configure Integration and Data Foundation

Business purpose

The company prepares the data foundation required to connect partner workflows to sales, finance, billing, and executive reporting.

Product capabilities required

- Integration Setup Wizard
- CRM Field Mapping
- Data Quality Engine
- Integration Health Monitor
- Import/Export Tools
- Data Warehouse Export
- Identity Resolution
- Sync Logs
- Admin Configuration

Backend business process

1. Admin selects integration type.
2. System requests credentials or import file.
3. Admin maps fields to Partner Revenue OS objects.
4. System runs sample sync or sample import.
5. Data quality engine checks duplicates, missing fields, invalid mappings, and sync errors.
6. Admin resolves mapping issues.
7. System activates integration.
8. Integration health monitor tracks sync status, errors, and latency.
9. Audit log records integration configuration and changes.

Required integrations by maturity

Stage	Integration requirement
MVP	CSV import/export, CRM link, basic CRM lookup, manual finance evidence export
V1	Native CRM integration, CRM write-back, data warehouse export, finance evidence pack
V2	Billing integration, ERP/accounting integration, invoice matching, collection validation
V3	Advanced forecasting, incentive simulation, partner ROI, payment/reconciliation integration

Controls

- Integration errors should not fail silently.
- Sync logs must be visible to admin users.
- Field mappings must be versioned.
- Data imports should have preview and rollback options.

- Write-back to CRM should be selective and controlled.

Rationale

The OS can only become the partner revenue control layer if it connects to the systems where sales and finance reality live. However, integrations should be phased. Heavy integration too early slows adoption.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	CRM, billing, ERP/accounting, CLM, BI, SSO, data warehouse
Replaces	Manual CSV chaos over time, not on day one
Adds	Integration health, data quality, identity matching, system trust

KPIs

- sync success rate
- integration uptime
- failed webhook count
- data completeness score
- duplicate account rate
- CRM write-back adoption

Phase 8 — Onboard and Activate Partner

Business purpose

The company gives the partner the knowledge, access, rules, and operating process needed to contribute correctly.

Product capabilities required

- Partner Onboarding Workspace
- Partner Portal Access
- Onboarding Checklist
- Document Collection
- Enablement Content
- Certification Tracking
- Payout Readiness Checklist
- Partner Activation Score

Backend business process

1. Approved partner enters onboarding lifecycle stage.
2. System loads onboarding checklist based on partner role and program.
3. Partner receives portal invitation.
4. Partner completes company profile, contacts, documents, and payout readiness fields.
5. Internal owner reviews submitted information.
6. Finance validates payment/tax documentation where applicable.
7. Partner completes training or enablement steps.
8. System marks required onboarding tasks as complete.
9. Partner lifecycle status changes to Activated only when minimum requirements are complete.

Required onboarding components

- partner profile completion
- key contacts
- role and program explanation

- rules of engagement
- deal/claim submission process
- evidence requirements
- protection rules
- payout rules
- statement process
- dispute process
- legal/compliance documents
- enablement materials
- sales handoff guide
- support contacts

Controls

- Partner should not submit payout-bearing claims until required documents are complete.
- Partner should not see internal data beyond permission scope.
- Partner onboarding completion should be auditable.
- Payout readiness should be separate from commercial activation.

Rationale

A signed partner is not an activated partner. The partner must know how to work with the company. Clear onboarding reduces rejected claims, weak evidence, partner frustration, and sales conflict.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Partner Registry, Partner Portal, Agreement Rulebook, Payout Readiness, Enablement
Replaces	Manual partner onboarding emails and inconsistent instructions
Adds	Activation checklist, training status, payout readiness, partner trust foundation

KPIs

- invitation-to-activation time
- onboarding completion rate
- partner portal activation rate
- payout readiness completion rate
- first claim time
- first accepted claim time

Phase 9 — Capture Ecosystem Touchpoints

Business purpose

The company captures meaningful partner actions before, during, and after a formal revenue claim. This is the core expansion capability of the **Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub**.

Touchpoint examples

- partner introduced buyer
- partner submitted a lead
- partner attended discovery call
- partner supported technical validation
- partner influenced procurement
- partner provided customer reference

- partner generated marketplace lead
- partner co-hosted campaign
- partner supported implementation
- partner helped adoption
- partner supported renewal
- partner helped expansion
- partner resolved customer blocker
- partner created integration

Product capabilities required

- Ecosystem Touchpoint Ledger
- Touchpoint Type Library
- Evidence Attachment
- Account/Contact Matching
- Journey Stage Mapping
- Contribution Classification
- Touchpoint Confidence Score
- Ecosystem Journey Timeline

Backend business process

1. Touchpoint is created manually, imported, or generated by integration.
2. System identifies source system and timestamp.
3. System attempts to match touchpoint to partner, account, contact, opportunity, and program.
4. Data quality engine assigns matching confidence.
5. System classifies touchpoint type and journey stage.
6. System checks whether touchpoint may support existing claim, trigger new claim, or remain as strategic influence.
7. Touchpoint appears in account timeline and partner timeline.
8. Audit log records source and matching logic.

Required data fields

- touchpoint ID
- partner ID
- partner contact
- customer account
- customer contact
- opportunity if known
- touchpoint type
- journey stage
- timestamp
- source system
- evidence artifact
- contribution category
- matching confidence
- owner
- status

Controls

- Touchpoints imported from external systems should show source and reliability.
- Low-confidence matches should route to review.
- Sensitive communication data should require permission and privacy controls.
- Touchpoints alone should not automatically create payout eligibility.

Rationale

Many partner contributions never become formal claims. They happen in meetings, introductions, implementation, events, marketplaces, product usage, customer success interactions, and executive relationships. The Hub captures these signals so the organization can see the real ecosystem journey.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	CRM activities, marketing tools, marketplace data, product usage, CS/support, partner portal
Replaces	Manual narrative reconstruction of partner influence
Adds	Touchpoint event stream, journey timeline, unclaimed influence visibility

KPIs

- touchpoints captured per account
 - touchpoints linked to opportunities
 - low-confidence match rate
 - unclaimed influence detected
 - touchpoint-to-claim conversion rate
-

Phase 10 — Create Partner Revenue Claim

Business purpose

A partner or internal user creates a formal claim that the partner contributed to a revenue outcome. This is the core operating event of the OS.

Claim types

- partner-sourced lead
- partner-sourced opportunity
- partner-influenced opportunity
- co-sell opportunity
- reseller transaction
- distributor transaction
- referral claim
- implementation contribution
- marketplace claim
- renewal influence
- expansion influence
- strategic alliance influence

Product capabilities required

- Partner Revenue Claim Ledger
- Deal Registration
- Claim Submission Form
- Evidence Upload
- Partner Role Capture
- Agreement Linkage
- CRM Opportunity Link
- Claim Status Engine

Backend business process

1. Claim is submitted by partner or internal user.
2. System validates required fields based on partner role and claim type.
3. System checks if partner is active and eligible to submit this claim type.
4. System matches customer/account/contact to CRM or creates pending account review.
5. System checks for duplicate claims and existing protection windows.
6. System links claim to agreement rulebook where possible.
7. System assigns claim owner and review workflow.
8. Claim status becomes Submitted or Needs Information.
9. Audit log records claim creation and source.

Required data fields

- claim ID
- partner ID
- partner role
- partner program
- claim type
- customer/account
- contact
- opportunity if known
- product/service
- estimated value
- expected close date
- submission date
- evidence
- agreement ID
- owner
- status

Controls

- Claims must be time-stamped.
- Claim source must be recorded.
- Required evidence depends on claim type.
- Duplicate detection should happen before review.
- Claims without agreement coverage can be accepted for attribution but should not be payout-eligible unless exception is approved.

Rationale

The claim is where partner activity becomes a controlled business object. Before the claim, the organization has activity. After the claim, it has something it can validate, protect, attribute, link to revenue, and review financially.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Partner Portal, CRM, Agreement Rulebook, Attribution Workflow, Evidence Layer
Replaces	Simple deal registration form as the main value object
Adds	Revenue claim ledger, commercial validation, finance pathway

KPIs

- claim submission volume
- claim completeness rate
- claim acceptance rate

- claims needing evidence
- claims linked to CRM
- claims linked to agreement

Phase 11 — Run Claim Preflight

Business purpose

The OS checks whether the claim is complete, valid, eligible for review, and free from obvious conflicts.

Product capabilities required

- Claim Preflight Engine
- Duplicate Claim Detection
- Account Matching
- Agreement Eligibility Check
- Partner Status Check
- Evidence Completeness Check
- Protection Conflict Check
- Exception Queue

Backend business process

1. Preflight starts when claim is submitted.
2. System validates partner status.
3. System validates claim type eligibility.
4. System checks account/contact matching confidence.
5. System checks duplicate partner claims.
6. System checks existing protection windows.
7. System checks agreement rule coverage.
8. System checks required evidence.
9. System assigns preflight outcome: Pass, Needs Information, Duplicate Risk, Agreement Gap, Protection Conflict, Manual Review.
10. System routes claim to next workflow or exception queue.

Controls

- Claims with missing mandatory fields cannot move to attribution decision.
- Duplicate risk should not automatically reject high-value claims; it should route to review.
- Agreement gap should not block strategic attribution but should block payout eligibility.
- Every preflight flag must be visible to reviewer.

Rationale

Preflight prevents weak claims from becoming downstream chaos. It catches errors early before they cause sales conflict, partner frustration, finance uncertainty, or payout mistakes.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Claim Ledger, Partner Registry, CRM, Agreement Rulebook, Protection Engine
Replaces	Manual reviewer checklist
Adds	Automated data quality, duplicate risk, eligibility checks, exception routing

KPIs

- preflight pass rate
- duplicate claim rate

- missing evidence rate
 - agreement gap rate
 - average time in preflight
-

Phase 12 — Decide Attribution and Apply Protection

Business purpose

The company decides whether the partner deserves credit and whether the partner receives protection over the account, contact, opportunity, product, region, or revenue event.

Product capabilities required

- Attribution Workflow
- Attribution Decision Engine
- Protection Window Engine
- Approval Workflow
- Sales Confirmation
- Override Workflow
- Audit Trail
- Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub scoring layer

Backend business process

1. Claim enters attribution review.
2. System loads claim, evidence, agreement, touchpoints, CRM context, duplicate risks, and prior protection windows.
3. System recommends attribution outcome based on rules and evidence.
4. Sales owner confirms, challenges, or adds context.
5. Partner manager reviews contribution and evidence.
6. RevOps reviews data conflicts where needed.
7. Finance/legal review if attribution has payout or contractual implications.
8. Decision is recorded: accepted, rejected, partial, duplicate, needs evidence, disputed, or escalated.
9. If accepted, system creates protection window according to rulebook.
10. System writes relevant status back to CRM if configured.

Attribution decision statuses

- submitted
- under review
- accepted
- partially accepted
- rejected
- duplicate
- needs evidence
- protected
- expired
- disputed
- sales override requested
- finance review required

Protection logic

Protection can be applied by:

- account
- contact

- opportunity
- product
- region
- partner role
- claim type
- agreement rule
- time window
- activity requirement

Controls

- Attribution decision must have owner and timestamp.
- Rejection should require reason.
- Override should require reason and approver.
- Protection should have start date, end date, and scope.
- Expired protection should be visible before payout eligibility.

Rationale

Attribution is not only a data field. It is an economic and political decision. It affects partner trust, sales credit, payout liability, and executive reporting. Protection windows protect partners from being bypassed while protecting the company from indefinite claims.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	CRM, Claim Ledger, Agreement Rulebook, Sales Workflow, Finance Evidence
Replaces	Informal credit decisions, Slack approval, sales-partner arguments
Adds	Governed attribution, protection rights, evidence-backed decision trail

KPIs

- attribution decision time
- accepted claim rate
- rejected claim rate
- partial attribution rate
- protection window utilization
- sales override rate
- attribution dispute rate

Phase 13 — Advanced Multi-Touch Ecosystem Attribution

Business purpose

The OS identifies and scores multiple partner contributions across the customer journey. This is where the **Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub** becomes fully useful.

Product capabilities required

- Ecosystem Journey Timeline
- Contribution Taxonomy Engine
- Evidence Reliability Score
- Contribution Score
- Multi-Partner Credit Allocation
- Influence Decay Logic

- Account Relationship Graph
- Attribution Recommendation Engine

Backend business process

1. System collects all touchpoints related to account, contact, opportunity, claim, and revenue event.
2. System orders touchpoints chronologically.
3. System classifies each touchpoint by contribution type and journey stage.
4. System scores evidence quality.
5. System scores contribution strength.
6. System applies attribution model based on partner program and agreement rules.
7. System recommends credit allocation across partners.
8. Human approvers accept, adjust, reject, or escalate recommendation.
9. Final attribution allocation is recorded separately from payout eligibility.
10. Dashboards and partner statements update based on approved attribution visibility rules.

Contribution scoring dimensions

- timing relevance
- journey-stage relevance
- relationship proximity
- evidence strength
- sales confirmation
- customer confirmation
- opportunity movement after touchpoint
- revenue proximity
- uniqueness of contribution
- partner role fit
- agreement eligibility
- historical partner quality

Example score output

Partner A – Source contribution: 65% credit, high confidence
 Partner B – Technical validation: 20% credit, medium confidence
 Partner C – Implementation support: 15% credit, high confidence
 Payout eligibility: determined separately by agreement rules

Controls

- Attribution score should support recommendation, not automatically create payout.
- Multi-partner allocation must distinguish reporting credit from financial entitlement.
- Human override must be recorded.
- Model versions must be tracked.

Rationale

Enterprise partnerships are rarely single-touch. One partner may source the lead, another may validate the solution, another may implement it, and another may support renewal. The OS must make that complexity visible without creating payout confusion.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Current Attribution Workflow and Protection Engine
Replaces	One-partner-per-deal logic
Adds	Multi-touch contribution, scoring, journey timeline, split attribution, influence decay

KPIs

- percentage of claims with multiple ecosystem touchpoints
 - multi-partner attribution rate
 - score confidence distribution
 - human override rate
 - partner influence by journey stage
 - unclaimed contribution detected
-

Phase 14 — Link Claim to CRM and Sales Process

Business purpose

The OS connects partner revenue claims to the sales system of record so partner contribution becomes visible in pipeline and forecast.

Product capabilities required

- CRM Link
- CRM Native Integration
- CRM Write-Back
- Account Matching
- Opportunity Matching
- Sales Notification
- CRM Sync Monitor

Backend business process

1. Accepted or review-ready claim searches for CRM account/contact/opportunity.
2. System matches records using account name, domain, contact email, CRM ID, CR/VAT where available, and manual review.
3. If opportunity exists, system links claim.
4. If opportunity does not exist, system creates task or prompts CRM opportunity creation depending on configuration.
5. System writes selected partner fields back to CRM.
6. Sales owner receives notification.
7. CRM sync health is monitored.
8. Claim status updates when CRM opportunity stage changes.

Recommended CRM write-backs

- partner involved: yes/no
- partner name
- partner role
- partner claim ID
- attribution status
- protection window expiry
- payout eligibility flag
- dispute flag
- partner owner
- link to OS record

Controls

- Do not overload CRM with finance-sensitive details.
- Write-back fields should be configurable.
- Sales should be able to see partner context with minimal data entry.
- CRM sync errors should route to admin queue.

Rationale

Sales lives in CRM. If partner attribution is not visible in CRM, sales adoption will be weak and attribution quality will suffer. The OS should add partner revenue control without forcing sales into another system unnecessarily.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Salesforce, HubSpot, Microsoft Dynamics, Zoho CRM
Replaces	Manual partner notes in CRM and disconnected spreadsheets
Adds	Partner claim visibility, attribution status, protection alerts, CRM-linked controlled revenue

KPIs

- percentage of claims linked to CRM opportunities
 - CRM match confidence
 - CRM write-back success rate
 - sales confirmation rate
 - CRM sync error count
-

Phase 15 — Validate Revenue Event

Business purpose

The company confirms whether partner-attributed pipeline became real revenue. This is where the OS starts moving from commercial attribution to finance readiness.

Revenue statuses

- no opportunity yet
- opportunity created
- pipeline active
- closed-won
- closed-lost
- invoiced
- collected
- recognized
- refunded
- canceled
- adjusted
- renewed
- expanded
- contracted

Product capabilities required

- Revenue Event Object
- Billing Integration
- ERP/Accounting Reference
- Invoice Matching
- Collection Validation
- Manual Revenue Validation Workflow
- Revenue Status Confidence Score

Backend business process

1. CRM opportunity changes stage or billing/ERP event is imported.
 2. System creates or updates Revenue Event.
 3. System links revenue event to partner claim and opportunity.
 4. System checks agreement rule for revenue basis: closed-won, invoiced, collected, recognized, net revenue, margin, renewal, or expansion.
 5. System checks required revenue evidence.
 6. Revenue event status updates payout eligibility workflow.
 7. Finance can validate, reject, or request correction.
 8. Audit log records revenue event source and validation.

Revenue evidence examples

- closed-won CRM opportunity
- invoice ID
- invoice date
- invoice amount
- collection confirmation
- subscription ID
- renewal record
- payment reference
- revenue recognition reference
- refund/credit note

Controls

- Closed-won should not always equal payout-ready.
- Agreement rule determines the valid revenue basis.
- Refunds and cancellations must update payout eligibility.
- Manual adjustments require finance approval.

Rationale

Partner payout and executive reporting should connect to real revenue events, not just claims or CRM source fields. This protects the company from paying on weak or incomplete revenue evidence.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	CRM, billing, ERP/accounting, revenue recognition references
Replaces	Manual revenue matching and spreadsheet payout triggers
Adds	Revenue event validation, finance confidence, payout basis clarity

KPIs

- claims with revenue event linkage
- closed-won to revenue validation time
- revenue validation confidence score
- missing invoice rate
- collection validation rate
- refund adjustment rate

Phase 16 — Determine Payout Eligibility

Business purpose

The OS determines whether a partner is commercially eligible for payout based on attribution, agreement rules, protection, revenue event, and finance evidence.

Product capabilities required

- Payout Eligibility Preview
- Payout Eligibility Engine
- Agreement Rule Evaluation
- Estimated Payout Calculation
- Missing Conditions Checklist
- Finance Review Queue
- Payout Liability Dashboard

Backend business process

1. Revenue event reaches relevant trigger.
2. System loads claim, attribution, protection, partner status, agreement rules, and revenue event.
3. System checks all eligibility conditions.
4. System calculates estimated payout if rules support calculation.
5. System identifies missing conditions.
6. Claim is marked Eligible, Not Eligible, Finance Review Required, Missing Evidence, or Disputed.
7. Finance reviews payout eligibility when required.
8. Eligibility decision is recorded and linked to partner statement.

Eligibility checks

- active partner
- active agreement
- accepted attribution
- valid protection window
- eligible claim type
- eligible product
- eligible geography
- eligible customer type
- valid revenue event
- required invoice/collection evidence
- no unresolved dispute
- no exclusion rule
- no refund/clawback condition
- payout readiness complete

Controls

- Payout eligibility must show explanation.
- Missing condition should be visible.
- Finance override requires reason.
- Payout amount should be versioned if rules or revenue change.
- Payout eligibility does not equal payment execution.

Rationale

The CFO needs to know what the company may owe and why. Payout eligibility is the bridge between partnership activity and financial obligation.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Agreement Rulebook, Revenue Events, Finance Evidence, Partner Statement
Replaces	Manual payout calculations and informal entitlement decisions
Adds	Eligibility explanation, estimated liability, finance approval pathway

KPIs

- payout eligibility determination time
- payout-eligible revenue
- estimated payout liability
- missing condition rate
- finance approval time
- payout exception rate

Phase 17 — Create Finance Evidence Pack

Business purpose

The OS packages all evidence needed for finance, accounting, legal, audit, and executive review.

Product capabilities required

- Finance Evidence Pack
- Attribution Evidence Pack
- Exportable PDF/CSV
- Approval History
- Audit Log
- Evidence Provenance
- Finance Review Workflow

Backend business process

1. Claim reaches finance-review or payout-eligible status.
2. System assembles evidence from claim, partner, agreement, attribution, protection, CRM, revenue event, payout calculation, approvals, and disputes.
3. System checks evidence completeness.
4. Finance reviews evidence pack.
5. Finance approves, rejects, requests information, or adjusts.
6. Evidence pack is frozen for statement or payout batch when approved.
7. Any later changes create new version.

Evidence pack contents

- partner profile
- partner legal entity
- agreement reference
- agreement rule applied
- claim submission
- evidence artifacts
- attribution timeline
- attribution decision
- protection window
- CRM opportunity
- revenue event

- invoice/payment reference
- payout calculation
- approval history
- dispute history
- finance decision

Controls

- Evidence pack must show source of each item.
- Finance-approved versions should be immutable.
- Adjustments require new version.
- Missing evidence should block approval where required.

Rationale

Finance does not trust narratives. Finance trusts evidence, rule logic, approval history, and traceability. The evidence pack makes partner economics defensible.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Claim Ledger, Agreement Rulebook, CRM, Billing, ERP, Audit Log
Replaces	Manual payout support files and screenshot-based evidence collection
Adds	Finance-grade attribution evidence and audit package

KPIs

- evidence pack completeness score
- finance approval rate
- evidence rework rate
- audit issue count
- finance review cycle time

Phase 18 — Update Partner Statement

Business purpose

The company provides the partner with transparent status on submitted claims, accepted claims, rejected claims, protected deals, payout eligibility, paid amounts, adjustments, and disputes.

Product capabilities required

- Partner Statement Portal
- Statement Periods
- Claim Status Visibility
- Payout Status Visibility
- Rejection Reason Display
- PDF/CSV Export
- Partner Notification

Backend business process

1. Claim or payout eligibility status changes.
2. System determines what is visible to partner based on permissions and statement rules.
3. Statement record is updated.
4. Partner receives notification when action is needed or statement period is ready.
5. Partner can view claim status, payout status, missing information, rejection reasons, and dispute

- options.
- 6. Statement can be exported.
- 7. Partner acknowledgement or dispute is recorded.

Statement fields

- statement period
- partner legal entity
- submitted claims
- accepted claims
- rejected claims
- protected accounts/deals
- closed-won deals
- payout-eligible claims
- pending payouts
- approved payouts
- paid payouts
- adjustments
- disputes
- missing documents
- comments/reasons

Controls

- Partner should only see its own records.
- Internal finance-only fields should be hidden.
- Rejection reasons should be clear but controlled.
- Statements should be versioned once issued.

Rationale

Partner trust is an activation lever. Partners contribute more when they believe the process is fair, visible, and predictable. Statements reduce manual follow-up and prevent misunderstandings.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Partner Portal, Claim Ledger, Payout Eligibility, Finance Evidence
Replaces	Manual status emails and ad hoc payout updates
Adds	Transparent partner-facing statement and trust-building workflow

KPIs

- partner statement view rate
- statement dispute rate
- partner support tickets about payout/status
- statement issuance time
- partner satisfaction score

Phase 19 — Manage Disputes and Adjustments

Business purpose

The OS handles conflict around attribution, rejection, payout eligibility, protection, agreement interpretation, or payment status.

Dispute types

- attribution dispute
- duplicate claim dispute
- payout amount dispute
- rejection dispute
- protection window dispute
- sales ownership dispute
- agreement interpretation dispute
- revenue validation dispute
- statement dispute
- payment status dispute

Product capabilities required

- Dispute Management
- Dispute Case Object
- Evidence Upload
- Comment Thread
- SLA Tracking
- Escalation Workflow
- Adjustment Creation
- Decision Record
- Audit Trail

Backend business process

1. Partner or internal user opens dispute.
2. System captures disputed object: claim, attribution, payout, statement, agreement, protection, or revenue event.
3. Dispute category determines owner and approval path.
4. System attaches relevant evidence and history.
5. Required stakeholders provide input: partnerships, sales, finance, legal, RevOps.
6. Decision is made: uphold, adjust, reject, escalate, or reopen.
7. If adjustment is needed, system creates adjustment record.
8. Claim, payout, statement, and dashboards update.
9. Audit log records final decision and rationale.

Controls

- Disputes should have owner and SLA.
- Final decision requires reason.
- Financial adjustment requires finance approval.
- Legal-sensitive disputes can have restricted visibility.
- Repeat disputes should trigger program-level review.

Rationale

Disputes are not edge cases. They appear when partner revenue becomes economically meaningful. A formal dispute workflow prevents chaos, protects partner trust, and creates organizational learning.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Claim Ledger, Attribution Workflow, Finance Evidence, Partner Statement, Legal
Replaces	Slack fights, email escalation, executive intervention without evidence
Adds	Structured dispute case, SLA, decision trail, adjustment logic

KPIs

- dispute volume
- dispute rate by partner type
- average dispute resolution time
- dispute recurrence rate
- adjustment amount
- dispute aging

Phase 20 — Reconcile and Prepare Settlement

Business purpose

The company reconciles approved partner obligations against finance systems and prepares payout or settlement workflow. Full payment execution may come later in the product roadmap.

Product capabilities required

- Settlement Readiness Record
- Payout Batch Export
- ERP Payment File Export
- Payment Status Import
- Statement-to-Payment Reconciliation
- Payable Aging
- Adjustment Handling
- Failed Payout Tracking

Backend business process

1. Finance-approved payout eligibility records enter settlement queue.
2. System groups eligible records by partner, statement period, currency, entity, and payment readiness.
3. System checks required tax, bank, and compliance documents.
4. System generates payout batch or ERP export file.
5. Finance reviews and approves batch.
6. Payment status is imported or updated manually.
7. Partner statement updates payment status.
8. Reconciliation differences create exception tasks.

Controls

- Settlement should not happen before finance approval.
- Payment readiness must be checked.
- Bank and tax documents must be valid.
- Payout batch must be versioned.
- Failed payments must create exception queue.

Rationale

Payment automation should come only after entitlement is trusted. The product should first become strong at eligibility, evidence, and reconciliation before directly moving money.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	ERP/accounting, payment rails, partner statements, finance approval
Replaces	Manual payout spreadsheets and disconnected bank files over time

Type	Description
Adds	Settlement readiness, payout batch control, reconciliation, payable aging

KPIs

- approved payout amount
- payout batch accuracy
- payment failure rate
- payable aging
- reconciliation exception count
- time from eligibility to payment status update

Phase 21 — Review Partner Performance and P&L

Business purpose

The company reviews whether each partner, partner type, program, geography, and commercial model is economically valuable.

Product capabilities required

- Partner Revenue Command Center
- Partner P&L
- Partner ROI
- Partner Cohort Analysis
- Partner Health Score
- Partner Concentration Risk
- Program Profitability
- Revenue Leakage Report
- Shadow Revenue Report

Backend business process

1. System aggregates claims, attribution, revenue events, payout eligibility, paid amounts, disputes, support cost, enablement cost, and co-marketing cost.
2. System calculates partner-level and program-level economics.
3. System identifies top partners, weak partners, risky partners, and high-potential partners.
4. System creates review pack for Head of Partnerships, CRO, CFO, and CEO/GM.
5. Leadership decisions are recorded as operating actions.
6. Actions trigger workflows: tier change, renegotiation, investment, dormancy, termination, enablement, or incentive redesign.

Partner P&L fields

- partner-sourced revenue
- partner-influenced revenue
- gross margin
- payout cost
- co-marketing cost
- enablement cost
- support cost
- dispute cost proxy
- implementation cost proxy
- net contribution
- ROI
- payback

- strategic value score

Controls

- Partner ROI should separate sourced revenue, influenced revenue, and payout cost.
- Partner P&L should distinguish hard financial cost from estimated operating cost.
- Executive reports should show data confidence.
- Actions should be tracked after review.

Rationale

The final value of the OS is not reporting. It is better capital allocation. Leadership needs to know where to invest more, where to reduce support, where to renegotiate, and where to exit.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Command Center, Finance, CRM, Billing, Partner Statements, Disputes
Replaces	Manual QBR decks and anecdotal partner performance claims
Adds	Partner economics, ROI, concentration risk, investment recommendations

KPIs

- partner ROI
- partner contribution margin
- revenue per active partner
- active-to-producing partner ratio
- partner concentration risk
- partner program profitability
- accepted investment recommendations

Phase 22 — Executive Operating Review and Investment Decision

Business purpose

The company uses OS data to make partner investment decisions at monthly and quarterly cadence.

Product capabilities required

- Quarterly CRO/CFO Pack
- CEO/Strategy Dashboard
- Partner Investment Recommendations
- Partner Tier Review
- Incentive Simulation
- Program Design Cockpit
- Decision Log
- Operating Action Tracker

Backend business process

1. System generates monthly/quarterly review pack.
2. Head of Partnerships reviews partner pipeline, claims, attribution, and program health.
3. CRO reviews pipeline, win rate, sales cycle, channel conflict, and forecast.
4. CFO reviews payout liability, evidence quality, disputes, and economics.
5. CEO/GM reviews partner ROI, concentration risk, market coverage, and investment recommendations.
6. Decisions are made: scale, maintain, fix, renegotiate, pause, terminate, or redesign.

7. System records decisions and creates follow-up workflows.
8. Next review measures whether decisions improved outcomes.

Decision types

- increase partner investment
- reduce partner investment
- change partner tier
- renegotiate agreement
- redesign incentive
- change protection window
- add co-marketing budget
- add enablement resources
- terminate partner
- launch new partner program
- pause underperforming program
- escalate strategic partner

Controls

- Recommendations should show rationale.
- Decisions should be linked to data.
- Follow-up actions should have owner and due date.
- Executive packs should show data quality and confidence level.

Rationale

Partner Revenue OS becomes strategic when it helps leadership allocate resources better. The product must convert workflow history into executive decisions.

Integrates / replaces / adds

Type	Description
Integrates	Governance Cadence Layer, Intelligence Layer, Partner P&L, Forecasting
Replaces	Static partner reporting and subjective executive reviews
Adds	Decision intelligence, action tracking, investment governance

KPIs

- partner investment decisions supported by system data
- action completion rate
- ROI improvement after decisions
- forecast accuracy
- program profitability change
- executive pack adoption

PART B — INTEGRATION WORKFLOW MANUAL

23. Integration Workflow Overview

Integration philosophy

The product should integrate in a phased way:

Manual-safe workflow

- CSV import/export
- CRM link
- CRM native integration
- selective CRM write-back
- billing event import
- ERP/accounting reference integration
- reconciliation integration
- data warehouse export
- advanced automation

The goal is to reduce time-to-value. Customers should be able to start with limited integration, then mature into deeper system connectivity.

24. CRM Integration Workflow

Systems

- Salesforce
- HubSpot
- Microsoft Dynamics
- Zoho CRM

Business purpose

Connect partner claims and attribution to sales pipeline.

Objects to ingest

- accounts
- contacts
- leads
- opportunities
- stages
- owners
- products
- close dates
- amounts
- source fields
- campaign fields
- custom partner fields
- activities where allowed

Write-back objects/fields

- partner involved
- partner name
- partner role
- claim ID
- attribution status
- protection window expiry
- payout eligibility flag
- dispute flag
- partner owner
- OS record link

Backend workflow

1. Admin connects CRM.
2. Admin maps CRM fields to OS objects.
3. System imports accounts, contacts, opportunities, and owners.
4. Identity resolution matches claims to CRM records.
5. Review queue handles low-confidence matches.
6. Accepted matches link claim to CRM opportunity.
7. System writes selected partner fields back to CRM.
8. CRM stage changes update revenue status in OS.
9. Sync monitor tracks health and errors.

Controls

- Use read-first integration before write-back.
- Write back only controlled fields.
- Do not expose payout details in CRM unless configured.
- Maintain integration logs.

Rationale

CRM is where pipeline lives. Partner attribution must connect to CRM, but the OS should own partner revenue governance.

25. Partner Portal Integration Workflow

Business purpose

Allow external partners to submit claims, upload evidence, view status, receive statements, and raise disputes.

Backend workflow

1. Partner receives portal invitation.
2. Partner completes profile and onboarding fields.
3. Partner submits claim or touchpoint.
4. System validates role, agreement, required evidence, and account match.
5. Partner sees claim status based on visibility permissions.
6. Partner receives requests for missing information.
7. Partner views statements and payout status.
8. Partner can open dispute where allowed.

Controls

- External users should only see their own data.
- Field-level permissions must separate internal and partner-facing data.
- Partner statement visibility should be configurable.

Rationale

Partner transparency increases partner trust and reduces manual support burden.

26. Marketing and Campaign Integration Workflow

Systems

- HubSpot Marketing
- Marketo
- Salesforce Marketing Cloud
- Mailchimp

- webinar tools
- event platforms
- campaign tracking systems

Business purpose

Capture early partner influence before sales opportunity creation.

Data to ingest

- campaign ID
- partner campaign ID
- event attendance
- webinar attendance
- UTM source
- lead source
- lead score
- partner co-marketing source
- conversion events

Backend workflow

1. Campaign data is imported.
2. System identifies partner-tagged campaign or event source.
3. System matches leads to accounts and contacts.
4. System creates ecosystem touchpoint.
5. Touchpoint appears in account journey timeline.
6. If lead converts to opportunity, touchpoint can support attribution.

Rationale

Many partner contributions happen before a formal sales opportunity exists. Marketing integration helps identify early influence.

27. Marketplace Integration Workflow

Business purpose

Capture attribution from app stores, cloud marketplaces, procurement platforms, and partner marketplaces.

Data to ingest

- marketplace lead
- marketplace listing view
- marketplace offer
- transaction ID
- customer account
- private offer
- co-sell reference
- transaction status
- marketplace source

Backend workflow

1. Marketplace event is imported.
2. System creates marketplace touchpoint.
3. System matches customer to CRM account or pending account review.
4. System classifies contribution as marketplace sourced, marketplace influenced, or marketplace transacted.

5. If opportunity/revenue exists, system links touchpoint to claim or creates suggested claim.
6. Attribution rules determine credit and eligibility.

Rationale

Marketplace motion is often underreported in CRM. The OS should unify marketplace attribution with partner revenue claims.

28. Customer Success and Support Integration Workflow

Systems

- Gainsight
- Totango
- ChurnZero
- Zendesk
- Intercom
- Freshdesk
- Jira Service Management
- ServiceNow

Business purpose

Capture post-sale partner contribution to implementation, adoption, retention, renewal, and expansion.

Data to ingest

- onboarding status
- implementation milestones
- support tickets
- customer health score
- renewal risk
- expansion opportunity
- partner involvement
- issue resolution

Backend workflow

1. CS/support event is imported.
2. System identifies partner involvement.
3. System creates post-sale ecosystem touchpoint.
4. Touchpoint is linked to customer account and revenue lifecycle.
5. If renewal or expansion occurs, touchpoint can support post-sale attribution.
6. Partner ROI reflects retention and expansion influence where configured.

Rationale

Some partners create their highest value after the initial sale. Implementation and adoption partners can improve retention and expansion even if they did not source the original deal.

29. Billing Integration Workflow

Systems

- Stripe Billing
- Chargebee
- Zuora

- Recurly
- Paddle
- Adyen
- Checkout.com
- HyperPay

Business purpose

Validate whether attributed revenue actually materialized.

Data to ingest

- customer ID
- subscription ID
- invoice ID
- invoice amount
- payment status
- collection date
- renewal
- upgrade
- downgrade
- refund
- cancellation
- currency

Backend workflow

1. Billing event is imported.
2. System matches customer/subscription to CRM account and partner claim.
3. System creates or updates Revenue Event.
4. Agreement rule determines whether billing event triggers payout eligibility.
5. Refunds, downgrades, cancellations, and credit notes update eligibility or adjustments.
6. Finance evidence pack receives billing reference.

Rationale

Billing proves revenue reality. It tells the OS whether partner-attributed pipeline became invoice, collection, renewal, refund, or churn.

30. ERP and Accounting Integration Workflow

Systems

- SAP
- Oracle
- NetSuite
- Microsoft Dynamics Finance
- QuickBooks
- Xero
- Odoo

Business purpose

Connect payout eligibility to finance systems for invoice, vendor, payment, tax, and GL validation.

Data to ingest/export

- customer invoice

- invoice amount
- invoice date
- payment status
- partner vendor record
- partner invoice
- payment batch
- credit note
- refund
- tax reference
- GL account
- settlement status

Backend workflow

1. ERP/accounting data is imported or referenced.
2. System matches invoice/payment records to revenue events.
3. Finance validates payout eligibility using evidence pack.
4. Approved payout records are exported to ERP or payout batch.
5. Payment status is imported back to OS.
6. Partner statement updates settlement status.
7. Reconciliation exceptions create finance tasks.

Rationale

ERP is where finance trust lives. The OS should not force deep ERP integration at MVP, but it must support finance-grade reconciliation as the product matures.

31. CLM and E-Signature Integration Workflow

Systems

- DocuSign
- Adobe Sign
- PandaDoc
- Ironclad
- ContractBook
- SharePoint
- Google Drive

Business purpose

Link signed agreements to operational rule metadata.

Data to ingest

- agreement ID
- signed PDF link
- effective date
- expiry date
- legal entity
- agreement type
- commission terms
- eligible products
- renewal terms
- termination terms

Backend workflow

1. Signed agreement is imported or linked.
2. System extracts or receives agreement metadata.
3. Admin/legal validates metadata.
4. Commercial rules are configured.
5. Agreement rulebook becomes active after approval.
6. Claims evaluate against active agreement rules.

Rationale

The product should not become a full CLM at the start. It should own agreement metadata and commercial rule execution.

32. Identity, SSO, and Permission Workflow

Systems

- Okta
- Microsoft Entra ID
- Google Workspace
- Auth0
- OneLogin

Business purpose

Control secure access for internal users and external partner users.

Backend workflow

1. Admin configures identity provider.
2. Internal users are provisioned through SSO/SCIM.
3. External partner users are invited or provisioned.
4. Role-based permissions determine object, field, and action access.
5. Approval authority is assigned based on role and delegation of authority.
6. Access changes are audited.

Rationale

Partner Revenue OS contains sensitive commercial and financial information. Permission design is not just IT hygiene; it is trust infrastructure.

33. Data Warehouse and BI Integration Workflow

Systems

- Snowflake
- BigQuery
- Redshift
- Databricks
- Power BI
- Tableau
- Looker

Business purpose

Allow enterprise customers to use partner revenue data in existing analytics environments.

Data to export

- partner master
- partner claims
- attribution decisions
- ecosystem touchpoints
- revenue events
- payout eligibility
- partner statements
- disputes
- approvals
- partner P&L
- program performance

Backend workflow

1. Admin configures export destination.
 2. System exports governed partner revenue tables.
 3. Data dictionary is provided.
 4. Export jobs are monitored.
 5. Failed exports trigger admin alerts.
 6. BI tools consume clean partner revenue dataset.

Rationale

The OS can be the system of truth while still allowing data to flow into enterprise analytics. Data portability increases trust.

PART C — ADVANCED ECOSYSTEM ATTRIBUTION HUB GAP ANALYSIS

34. Capability Gap Analysis

Current OS capability	Current strength	Gap	Required Hub capability	Rationale
Partner Revenue Claim Ledger	Strong core object for partner revenue control	Misses influence not submitted as claims	Ecosystem Touchpoint Ledger	Captures partner activity before formal claims
Attribution Workflow	Governs accepted/rejected attribution	Too binary for complex enterprise deals	Contribution Scoring	Supports partial and confidence-based attribution
Protection Window Engine	Protects accepted claims	Static protection may over-credit old influence	Influence Decay	Reduces credit over time unless contribution continues
Partner Registry	Captures partner identity	Limited ecosystem actor model	Ecosystem Actor Registry	Includes partner contacts, customer contacts, internal users, platform actors
CRM Link	Links claims to opportunities	Weak account/contact matching creates errors	Identity Resolution Engine	Matches entities across CRM, portal, billing, marketplace, and data warehouse
Agreement Rulebook	Applies commercial rules	May not map rules to different contribution types	Agreement-to-Attribution Mapping	Connects source, influence, co-sell, implementation, renewal, and expansion rules

Current OS capability	Current strength	Gap	Required Hub capability	Rationale
Payout Eligibility Preview	Shows potential payout liability	Can confuse attribution with payout	Attribution-to-Eligibility Bridge	Separates contribution recognition from financial obligation
Partner Statements	Shows claims and payout status	Limited explanation of attribution	Partner Attribution Statement	Explains accepted, rejected, partial, protected, expired, and disputed attribution
Dispute Management	Resolves disputes once raised	Reactive	Proactive Conflict Detection	Flags likely disputes before escalation
Executive Dashboard	Shows partner revenue and claims	May not explain causality	Ecosystem Attribution Command Center	Shows partner influence, journey-stage impact, ROI, confidence, and investment recommendations

35. What the Hub Integrates, Replaces, and Adds

35.1 Integrates with current structure

The Hub integrates with:

- Partner Registry
- Partner Revenue Claim Ledger
- Attribution Workflow
- Protection Window Engine
- Agreement Rulebook
- Payout Eligibility Preview
- Finance Evidence Pack
- Partner Statements
- Dispute Management
- Partner Revenue Command Center
- CRM integration
- Billing integration
- ERP/accounting integration
- Data warehouse export

35.2 Replaces weak manual processes

The Hub replaces:

- single CRM lead-source logic
- spreadsheet partner attribution
- partner manager memory
- manual account mapping
- Slack/email approval chains
- one-partner-per-deal assumptions
- manual QBR performance narratives
- reactive dispute discovery
- screenshot-based evidence collection
- informal revenue influence claims

35.3 Adds new product capabilities

The Hub adds:

- Ecosystem Touchpoint Ledger
- Ecosystem Actor Registry
- Ecosystem Relationship Graph

- Customer Journey Timeline
- Contribution Taxonomy Engine
- Evidence Reliability Score
- Contribution Score
- Multi-Partner Credit Allocation
- Influence Decay
- Identity Resolution Engine
- Proactive Conflict Detection
- Attribution-to-Eligibility Bridge
- Partner Attribution Statement
- Ecosystem Attribution Command Center
- Partner ROI Decomposition
- Incentive Simulation

PART D — BACKEND DOMAIN OBJECTS AND PROCESS LOGIC

36. Core Domain Objects

Existing PDR objects to preserve

- Partner
- Partner Contact
- Partner User
- Internal User
- Partner Organization
- Agreement
- Agreement Rule
- Product / SKU
- Customer Account
- Customer Contact
- Lead
- Opportunity / Deal
- Deal Registration
- Partner Revenue Claim
- Attribution Decision
- Protection Window
- Evidence Item
- Revenue Event
- Payout Eligibility Record
- Partner Statement
- Invoice Reference
- Payment Reference
- Dispute
- Approval
- Task
- Activity

- Audit Log
- Partner Tier
- Partner Program
- Partner P&L Record
- Forecast Record

New objects for Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub

Object	Purpose
Ecosystem Touchpoint	Captures a partner-related event or interaction
Contribution Event	A touchpoint that may influence attribution
Ecosystem Actor	Any relevant actor: partner, buyer, internal user, platform, marketplace, consultant, integrator
Relationship Edge	Connects actors, accounts, contacts, opportunities, and revenue events
Journey Timeline	Chronological account/opportunity view of touchpoints
Evidence Provenance Record	Captures source and reliability of evidence
Contribution Score	Quantifies contribution strength
Credit Allocation	Splits attribution across partners or touchpoints
Influence Decay Record	Reduces attribution weight over time
Attribution Recommendation	System-generated recommendation before human approval
Attribution-to-Eligibility Record	Maps approved contribution to commercial rights
Conflict Signal	Early warning of duplicate, weak, late, or contested attribution

37. Event-Driven Backend Workflow Pattern

Every major product workflow should follow this backend pattern:

1. Event occurs.
2. Event is captured as object or object update.
3. Identity resolution matches related records.
4. Data quality engine checks completeness and confidence.
5. Rule engine evaluates applicable policies.
6. Workflow engine routes next action.
7. Notification engine alerts responsible users.
8. Audit log records the event.
9. Dashboard layer updates metrics.
10. Exception queue captures unresolved issues.

Example: Partner submits claim

```
Event: Partner submits claim
Object created: Partner Revenue Claim
Identity resolution: Match customer/account/contact/opportunity
Rules checked: partner status, agreement coverage, allowed claim type, evidence requirement
Workflow routed: partner manager review + sales confirmation
Audit log: claim creation
Dashboard update: submitted claims + pending review
Exception queue: duplicate risk or missing evidence
```

Example: Opportunity becomes closed-won

```
Event: CRM opportunity stage changes to closed-won
Object updated: Revenue Event
Rules checked: agreement payout trigger, attribution status, protection status
Workflow routed: payout eligibility review
Audit log: CRM sync update
```

38. Business Control Matrix

Control area	Risk without control	Required OS control
Partner identity	Duplicate or unverified partners	Partner registry, duplicate detection, KYB readiness
Partner role	Wrong claim or payout logic	Role taxonomy and allowed claim types
Agreement terms	Manual interpretation errors	Agreement rulebook and versioning
Claim creation	Informal and untracked contribution	Partner Revenue Claim Ledger
Attribution	Sales conflict and partner distrust	Attribution workflow and evidence trail
Protection	Partner bypass or indefinite claims	Protection window engine and expiry alerts
Revenue validation	Paying before revenue is real	Revenue event linkage and finance review
Payout eligibility	Overpayment or underpayment	Eligibility engine and missing-condition checklist
Evidence	CFO distrust	Finance evidence pack and provenance
Statements	Partner confusion	Partner statements and status transparency
Disputes	Executive escalation	Dispute workflow and SLA
Integrations	Silent data failure	Integration health monitor
Executive review	Poor capital allocation	Partner P&L, ROI, and investment recommendations

PART E — OPERATING CADENCE

39. Daily Operating Cadence

Users

Partner Managers, Partnerships Ops, Sales Owners, RevOps.

Activities

- review new partner intakes
- review new claims
- resolve missing evidence
- validate CRM matches
- respond to sales confirmation requests
- check expiring protection windows
- respond to partner questions
- clear integration errors

Product surfaces

- partner manager work queue
- claim review queue
- exception queue
- partner portal messages
- CRM match review
- protection alerts

40. Weekly Operating Cadence

Users

Head of Partnerships, Partner Managers, Sales Managers, RevOps.

Activities

- partner pipeline review
- accepted/rejected claim review
- top partner review
- sales conflict review
- unresolved disputes
- data quality review
- partner activation review

Product outputs

- weekly partner pipeline report
- claim aging report
- dispute aging report
- partner activation report
- sales conflict report
- data quality report

41. Monthly Operating Cadence

Users

Head of Partnerships, CRO, CFO delegate, RevOps, Finance Ops.

Activities

- controlled partner revenue review
- payout liability review
- finance evidence gaps
- partner performance review
- partner program profitability
- partner concentration risk
- underperforming partner watchlist
- payout and statement readiness

Product outputs

- monthly partner revenue pack
- payout liability dashboard
- partner P&L snapshot
- partner ROI dashboard
- risk and exception report

42. Quarterly Executive Cadence

Users

CEO/GM, CFO, CRO, Head of Partnerships, Strategy Office.

Activities

- strategic partner portfolio review
- program ROI review
- investment decisions
- incentive redesign
- tier changes
- renegotiation decisions
- termination decisions
- new program approvals

Product outputs

- Quarterly CRO/CFO Pack
- CEO/Strategy Dashboard
- partner investment recommendations
- incentive simulation
- partner concentration risk report
- program design recommendations

PART F — ROADMAP FOR BUSINESS WORKFLOW IMPLEMENTATION

43. MVP Workflow Scope — Control the Partner Revenue Claim

Build first

- Partner Registry
- Partner Program basic setup
- Partner Intake
- Agreement Metadata
- Deal Registration / Claim Submission
- Partner Revenue Claim Ledger
- Claim Preflight
- Attribution Workflow
- Basic Protection Window
- CRM Link
- Basic Payout Eligibility Preview
- Executive Dashboard
- Audit Log
- CSV Import/Export

Do not build yet

- complex AI scoring

- full ERP integration
- full payout execution
- full partner P&L
- full settlement automation
- advanced marketplace attribution
- complex multi-touch attribution beyond basic split support

MVP success definition

The MVP succeeds if it creates trusted partner revenue truth:

- partners can submit claims
 - internal teams can approve/reject attribution
 - sales can see partner involvement
 - protection windows are visible
 - claims link to CRM
 - payout eligibility can be previewed
 - executives can see controlled partner revenue
-

44. V1 Workflow Scope — Make Partner Revenue Operational

Add

- CRM native integration
- CRM write-back
- Partner Statements
- Dispute Management
- Finance Evidence Pack
- Data Quality Engine
- Integration Health Monitor
- Approval Matrix
- Quarterly CRO/CFO Pack
- Data Warehouse Export
- Basic Ecosystem Touchpoint Ledger
- Basic Journey Timeline

V1 success definition

The product becomes part of the operating rhythm of partnerships, sales, RevOps, and finance.

45. V2 Workflow Scope — Make Partner Revenue Finance-Ready

Add

- Billing integration
- ERP/accounting integration
- invoice matching
- collection validation
- payout liability
- payable aging
- adjustments
- refunds
- credit notes

- revenue recognition references
- advanced payout eligibility
- attribution evidence pack
- post-sale contribution tracking

V2 success definition

Finance trusts the OS as the controlled partner revenue evidence layer.

46. V3 Workflow Scope — Make Partner Revenue Investable

Add

- Partner P&L
- Partner ROI
- forecasting
- partner cohort analysis
- tier optimization
- incentive simulation
- partner concentration risk
- strategic partner planning
- program design cockpit
- advanced attribution scoring
- multi-touch credit allocation
- influence decay
- AI recommendations

V3 success definition

Leadership uses the OS to decide where to invest, scale, renegotiate, reduce, or terminate partner programs.

PART G — FINAL OPERATING BLUEPRINT

47. The complete business workflow in one view

1. Define partner strategy.
2. Create partner program thesis.
3. Define partner roles and contribution models.
4. Source potential partners.
5. Capture partner intake.
6. Qualify partner fit.
7. Approve partner internally.
8. Create partner operating record.
9. Structure agreement and commercial rules.
10. Configure integration and data foundation.
11. Onboard partner.
12. Activate partner.
13. Capture ecosystem touchpoints.
14. Submit partner revenue claim.
15. Run claim preflight.
16. Match claim to account/contact/opportunity.
17. Check duplicate claims and conflicts.
18. Review evidence.
19. Decide attribution.
20. Apply protection window.
21. Link claim to CRM.

22. Update sales workflow.
23. Capture revenue event.
24. Validate invoice/collection/revenue status.
25. Check payout eligibility.
26. Create finance evidence pack.
27. Update partner statement.
28. Resolve disputes and adjustments.
29. Reconcile payout readiness.
30. Review partner performance.
31. Calculate partner P&L and ROI.
32. Generate executive review pack.
33. Make investment decisions.
34. Update programs, tiers, rules, incentives, and partner portfolio.

48. Final product interpretation

The end-to-end business workflow should make the company able to answer:

Who are our partners?
Why do they exist?
What role do they play?
What commercial rules govern them?
Which customers and opportunities did they touch?
What evidence proves their contribution?
Who deserves attribution?
Who deserves protection?
Which revenue actually happened?
What payout liability exists?
Which disputes or risks need resolution?
Which partners are profitable?
Which programs should be scaled or stopped?

The OS should not merely manage partners. It should govern the commercial truth of partner-led revenue.

The **Partner Revenue Claim** remains the atomic control object. The **Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub** adds the surrounding intelligence layer by capturing ecosystem touchpoints, scoring contribution, mapping the customer journey, resolving identity, supporting multi-touch attribution, and converting attribution into partner ROI and investment decisions.

The complete platform becomes:

Partner Operating Layer
+ Partner Revenue Claim Ledger
+ Advanced Ecosystem Attribution Hub
+ Attribution and Protection Layer
+ Agreement and Rule Engine
+ Revenue and Payout Eligibility Layer
+ Finance Evidence and Partner Statements
+ Governance and Operating Cadence Layer
+ Intelligence and Forecasting Layer
+ Platform, Admin, Security, and Integration Layer

The highest-level product promise is:

Partner Revenue OS helps companies convert partnership activity into governed, attributable, forecastable, finance-ready, and investable revenue.